Special Needs Co-Parenting Assessment Workbook

This 13-section assessment is a private planning tool. It is not a diagnosis of your child, is not a determination of parental fitness, and is not legal advice. Complete it from your own perspective - your co-parent will complete their own copy independently.

How to use this workbook

For each rated item, circle one option from the response scale below. For multi-select items, tick every box that applies. For open-ended prompts, write your answer on the lines provided. You do not need to finish in one sitting.

Response scale (Sections 2 to 12)

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Consistency scale (Section 6)

5. Consistent	4. Mostly consistent	3. Sometimes inconsistent	2. Frequently inconsistent	unknown. Unknown	na. Not applicable

Section 11 (Family Violence & Communication Safety) is kept private to you. It is never shared automatically with your co-parent and never included in a comparison view.

Section 1. About Your Child

Child's age and current grade.

What are your child's greatest strengths?

What activities, interests, or relationships bring your child joy?

Has your child received a diagnosis or professional evaluation?

- [ ] No diagnosis or evaluation
- [ ] Evaluation is being considered
- [ ] Evaluation is scheduled
- [ ] Evaluation is in progress
- [ ] Diagnosis or eligibility determination received
- [ ] Prefer not to answer

Which needs currently apply?

- [ ] Learning or academic
- [ ] Speech or language
- [ ] Autism-related
- [ ] ADHD or executive functioning
- [ ] Intellectual or developmental
- [ ] Physical or mobility
- [ ] Chronic medical
- [ ] Sensory processing
- [ ] Behavioral
- [ ] Anxiety or emotional regulation
- [ ]

Trauma-related

- [ ] Social development
- [ ] Sleep
- [ ] Feeding or nutrition
- [ ] Other

Briefly describe your understanding of your child's needs.

Section 2. Understanding and Acceptance

I understand my child's diagnosis, suspected condition, or areas of concern.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

I recognize how my child's needs affect daily life.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

I can separate my concerns about the other parent from my child's actual needs.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

I am willing to consider information that differs from my current understanding.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

I rely on qualified professionals when medical, educational, or developmental questions arise.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

I understand that my child may behave differently in each home.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

I believe the other parent's observations should be considered even when they differ from mine.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Both parents generally acknowledge that our child may need additional support.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Section 3. Medical and Mental Healthcare

Does your child currently receive care from any of the following?

- [ ] Pediatrician
- [ ] Medical specialist
- [ ] Psychiatrist
- [ ] Psychologist
- [ ] Counselor or therapist
- [ ] Occupational therapist
- [ ] Physical therapist
- [ ] Speech-language pathologist
- [ ] Behavioral specialist
- [ ] Other provider

I know the names and contact information of my child's providers.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

I receive timely information about appointments and recommendations.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Both parents can access appropriate medical records.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Recommended appointments are scheduled and attended.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Medications are administered consistently and as prescribed.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Medication changes and side effects are promptly shared.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Therapy exercises or treatment plans are followed in my home.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

I understand what to do during a medical or behavioral emergency.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

The parents have a workable process for resolving disagreements about treatment.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

What medical or mental-health needs require the greatest coordination?

Have appointments, medication, therapy, or treatment ever been delayed or missed? Explain.

What would improve consistency between homes?

Section 4. Kindergarten and Elementary School

What school does your child attend?

Does your child have any of the following?

- [ ] Individualized Education Program (IEP)
- [ ] Section 504 Plan
- [ ] Response to Intervention or MTSS support
- [ ] Behavior Intervention Plan
- [ ] Individualized Health Plan
- [ ] Classroom accommodations
- [ ] Informal teacher supports
- [ ] Evaluation pending
- [ ] None
- [ ] Unsure

I understand my child's educational plan and accommodations.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

I know who to contact at the school when concerns arise.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Both parents receive school notices, progress reports, and teacher communications.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Both parents attend or meaningfully participate in school meetings when appropriate.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Homework and reading expectations are reasonably consistent between homes.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

School supplies, technology, medication, and assistive devices travel reliably between homes.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Attendance and morning routines support my child's learning.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Both parents follow the child's educational plan.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Teachers receive consistent and accurate information from the parents.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Educational disagreements are handled without placing the child or school staff in the middle.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

What educational support is most important for your child?

What school-related problem occurs most often?

What changes would help your child succeed?

Section 5. Transitions, Pickup, and Drop-Off

My child understands the parenting-time schedule.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Pickup and drop-off times are predictable.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Necessary medication, schoolwork, clothing, comfort items, and equipment accompany the child.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Schedule changes are communicated early enough to support the child.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Exchanges occur without exposing the child to conflict.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Each parent understands the child's transition-related triggers.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

The child receives appropriate preparation before changing homes.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Both homes support calming or decompression time after transitions.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Transportation arrangements accommodate the child's physical, sensory, or behavioral needs.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

The parents have a backup plan when transportation or caregiving arrangements fail.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

What makes transitions difficult for your child?

Which items must always travel with your child?

Would a written transition checklist help?

- [ ] Yes
- [ ] No
- [ ] Unsure

Section 6. Daily Routines Across Homes

Sleep and bedtime

5. Consistent | 4. Mostly consistent | 3. Sometimes inconsistent | 2. Frequently inconsistent | unknown. Unknown | na. Not applicable

Morning routine

5. Consistent | 4. Mostly consistent | 3. Sometimes inconsistent | 2. Frequently inconsistent | unknown. Unknown | na. Not applicable

Medication

5. Consistent | 4. Mostly consistent | 3. Sometimes inconsistent | 2. Frequently inconsistent | unknown. Unknown | na. Not applicable

Meals and nutrition

5. Consistent | 4. Mostly consistent | 3. Sometimes inconsistent | 2. Frequently inconsistent | unknown. Unknown | na. Not applicable

Hygiene

5. Consistent | 4. Mostly consistent | 3. Sometimes inconsistent | 2. Frequently inconsistent | unknown. Unknown | na. Not applicable

Homework and reading

5. Consistent | 4. Mostly consistent | 3. Sometimes inconsistent | 2. Frequently inconsistent | unknown. Unknown | na. Not applicable

Screen time

5. Consistent | 4. Mostly consistent | 3. Sometimes inconsistent | 2. Frequently inconsistent | unknown. Unknown | na. Not applicable

Sensory supports

5. Consistent | 4. Mostly consistent | 3. Sometimes inconsistent | 2. Frequently inconsistent | unknown. Unknown | na. Not applicable

Behavioral expectations

5. Consistent | 4. Mostly consistent | 3. Sometimes inconsistent | 2. Frequently inconsistent | unknown. Unknown | na. Not applicable

Therapy exercises

5. Consistent | 4. Mostly consistent | 3. Sometimes inconsistent | 2. Frequently inconsistent | unknown. Unknown | na. Not applicable

Assistive devices

5. Consistent | 4. Mostly consistent | 3. Sometimes inconsistent | 2. Frequently inconsistent | unknown. Unknown | na. Not applicable

Emotional-regulation strategies

5. Consistent | 4. Mostly consistent | 3. Sometimes inconsistent | 2. Frequently inconsistent | unknown. Unknown | na. Not applicable

Which routines must remain consistent for your child to function well?

Where is flexibility appropriate?

Which differences between homes appear to negatively affect the child?

Section 7. Communication and Information Sharing

Parents exchange child-related information accurately and promptly.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Communications focus on the child rather than past relationship conflict.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Each parent provides updates after significant appointments or school meetings.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Both parents can ask reasonable questions without the conversation escalating.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Important decisions are confirmed in writing.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Parents avoid using the child as a messenger.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Professionals are not asked to take sides in parental disputes.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

A structured communication method would improve coordination.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Preferred communication structure

- [ ] Direct conversation
- [ ] Text message
- [ ] Email
- [ ] Co-parenting application
- [ ] BIFF-style written communication
- [ ] Communication through attorneys
- [ ] Communication through a parenting facilitator or coordinator
- [ ] Information exchanged directly through professionals
- [ ] Another structured method

Section 8. Special School Events

Consider (context only)

- [ ] Parent-teacher conferences
- [ ] IEP or Section 504 meetings
- [ ] School performances
- [ ] Field trips
- [ ] Awards ceremonies
- [ ] Class parties
- [ ] Testing days
- [ ] Therapy or intervention meetings
- [ ] School transitions
- [ ] Special-education evaluations

Both parents receive advance notice of important events.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Both parents understand who may attend.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

The child can participate without worrying about parental conflict.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Parents can attend together safely and appropriately when beneficial.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Separate attendance or virtual participation is available when needed.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Parents avoid discussing disputes during the event.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

A designated parent shares information when only one parent can attend.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

School staff understand the appropriate communication arrangement.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Section 9. Extracurricular Activities

What activities does your child currently participate in?

Does the activity support the child's interests, development, or therapeutic needs?

The activity is appropriate for the child's abilities and tolerance.

1. Strongly disagree | 2. Disagree | 3. Unsure | 4. Agree | 5. Strongly agree | na. Not applicable or unknown

Both parents receive schedules and contact information.

1. Strongly disagree | 2. Disagree | 3. Unsure | 4. Agree | 5. Strongly agree | na. Not applicable or unknown

Transportation responsibilities are clear.

1. Strongly disagree | 2. Disagree | 3. Unsure | 4. Agree | 5. Strongly agree | na. Not applicable or unknown

Equipment and uniforms are available when needed.

1. Strongly disagree | 2. Disagree | 3. Unsure | 4. Agree | 5. Strongly agree | na. Not applicable or unknown

Costs and payment responsibilities are understood.

1. Strongly disagree | 2. Disagree | 3. Unsure | 4. Agree | 5. Strongly agree | na. Not applicable or unknown

The activity does not create an unreasonable burden for the child.

1. Strongly disagree | 2. Disagree | 3. Unsure | 4. Agree | 5. Strongly agree | na. Not applicable or unknown

Coaches or instructors receive necessary medical or accommodation information.

1. Strongly disagree | 2. Disagree | 3. Unsure | 4. Agree | 5. Strongly agree | na. Not applicable or unknown

Parents behave appropriately when attending at the same time.

1. Strongly disagree | 2. Disagree | 3. Unsure | 4. Agree | 5. Strongly agree | na. Not applicable or unknown

The child is not pressured to choose which parent attends.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

There is a process for approving new activities.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Section 10. Decision-Making and Professional Guidance

A professional should not be designated as a binding tie-breaker unless the arrangement is legally permitted and clearly documented.

Parents can identify when a professional opinion is needed.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Decisions are based on the child's needs rather than parental control.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Both parents have an opportunity to provide relevant information.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Professional recommendations are documented and shared.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Parents understand who has legal authority to make particular decisions.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

There is a workable process for time-sensitive decisions.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

The child is not asked to decide disputes that belong to the adults.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Possible decision-support options (context)

- [ ] Joint consultation with the pediatrician
- [ ] Educational meeting with teachers or school specialists
- [ ] Neutral child therapist
- [ ] Developmental or neuropsychological evaluation
- [ ] Parenting facilitator or parenting coordinator
- [ ] Child-focused mediation
- [ ] Tie-breaking recommendation from an agreed professional
- [ ] Medical tie-breaker
- [ ] Mental-health tie-breaker
- [ ] Educational tie-breaker
- [ ] Court clarification when legal authority is disputed

Section 11. Family Violence and Communication Safety

This section should not produce a general co-parenting score. Safety concerns require an individualized response. A positive safety response should direct the parent to the app's full Family Violence-IPV Communication Safety Assessment.

Select any that apply.

- [ ] I am afraid of the other parent.
- [ ] Communications include threats, harassment, intimidation, or degrading language.
- [ ] The other parent monitors my location, devices, or accounts.
- [ ] Exchanges have involved threatening or unsafe behavior.
- [ ] The child has witnessed conflict, threats, or violence.
- [ ] A protective order or other safety restriction exists.
- [ ] Direct negotiation or joint mediation may not be safe.
- [ ] The other parent interferes with medical, educational, or therapeutic care as a means of control.
- [ ] None of these apply.
- [ ] Prefer not to answer.

Possible safeguards

- [ ] BIFF communication
- [ ] Parenting application with documented messages
- [ ] Communication limited to child-related information
- [ ] Separate arrival and departure times
- [ ] Neutral or supervised exchange location
- [ ] Third-party or professional exchanges
- [ ] Information provided directly by schools and medical providers
- [ ] Shuttle or separate-room mediation
- [ ] Attorney-assisted negotiation
- [ ] Separate professional consultations
- [ ] Safety planning with a qualified advocate
- [ ] Review by a family-law attorney
- [ ] Emergency or court intervention when necessary

Section 12. Parent Capacity and Support

I can remain regulated when discussing my child's needs.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

I can follow detailed care instructions.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

I have reliable transportation to appointments and school events.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

I can obtain necessary medication, equipment, and supplies.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

I have family, community, or professional support.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

I ask for help when I cannot meet a need.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

I am willing to learn new caregiving skills.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

My current stress level sometimes affects my ability to follow the child's plan.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

Financial or scheduling barriers interfere with services.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

I need additional training or support.

1. Strongly disagree	2. Disagree	3. Unsure	4. Agree	5. Strongly agree	na. Not applicable or unknown

What support would make it easier for you to meet your child's needs?

What is one caregiving responsibility you believe you manage well?

What is one area where you need help?

Section 13. Goals, Concerns, and Priorities

List your three most important goals for your child.

List your three greatest concerns.

What does your child need most from you?

What does your child need from the other parent?

What does your child need both parents to do consistently?

Which issue should be addressed first?

What professional information is still needed?

What agreement could the parents try during the next 30 days?

Assessment summary

This workbook contains 13 sections with 92 rated items plus intake, safety, and goals-and-priorities questions. When you complete this online at sacoparentsapp.online you receive an individual parent report you can share with mediators, teachers, or treating professionals - and, if your co-parent completes their own assessment, a neutral side-by-side.

This assessment does not diagnose your child, is not a finding of fact, and does not determine parental fitness. Safety responses are always kept private.